



Mark Dosen <mark@dosen1.com>

Re: Tennis Courts

1 message

Daniel Reynolds <reynoldsd@bbhcsd.org>

Sat, Sep 21, 2019 at 5:41 PM

To: Christopher Coad <coadc@bbhcsd.org>

Cc: Mark Maslona <maslonam@bbhcsd.org>, Mark Dosen <dosenm@bbhcsd.org>, Kathleen Mack <mackk@bbhcsd.org>, Ellen Kramer <kramere@bbhcsd.org>, Fred Pedersen <pedersenf@bbhcsd.org>, Joelle Magyar <magyarj@bbhcsd.org>, Michael Ziegler <zieglerm@bbhcsd.org>, Jeff Sidaway <sidawayj@bbhcsd.org>

Hello All -

There was a lot of information shared via email yesterday, and now that I have had this time to review it all, I would like to give my feedback, as well as clarify a few things. On Thursday, I was present for both meetings with the two companies that were called regarding the work, Industrial Surfaces and Vasco. I was able to hear first hand their thoughts on the various options that we have for the courts at their current site thus I can speak from what I heard at these meetings directly.

First, I will address the potential overlay quoted by Industrial Surfaces, while giving some information regarding the different types of overlays that are available to consumers, as there is great difference between them. The term "overlay" when used with tennis courts, can take many different meanings, and there are big levels of variance between the complexity of work that is done. The two main types of overlays are as follows:

1. Overlay type 1, which I described in my original email, which generally lasts 10+ years on average:

- All current cracks are filled and sealed,
- A mesh component is laid down over the **entire** surface,
- A layer of asphalt is added over top of that mesh component, roughly 2-3 inches thick, that provides a completely new level surface (All areas where there were puddling previously, are now level, however, if there is any degree of pitch in the sloping of a court, that is addressed differently, but is not an issue with our courts)
- Courts are then sealed and painted to specifications.

2. Overlay type 2, which is a cheaper alternative, and was done in 2009/2010, and generally lasts around 5+ years on average:

- All current cracks are filled and sealed,
- A mesh/tape component is laid down either over all of the surface, OR just the areas that are cracked,
- Courts are then sealed and painted to specifications.

As you can see from the description above, there is a big difference between the two types of "overlays", so I wanted to be clear that we were all speaking of the same type that I recommended, which is type 1. Joelle, I am not sure that the contractor and engineer were giving their basis in the email that you forwarded to us, based on the Overlay type 1. I was not able to bring up the recommendations that he was referencing as "being listed below", in his email, but if he is speaking of "puddling", and it "not being a good look to have an acrylic overlay, with puddling", I am guessing that he is thinking that we were recommending the cheaper alternative, which is listed as an Overlay 2 above. By adding the asphalt layer, that levels the surface, so there would be no lower lying areas for puddling to occur. Since I don't know what the original email said, I cannot speak to that though, rather base it on his reply, and what I know of the different types of overlays.

I will give some background below regarding the two companies that came out, and give my feedback regarding it all at the end.

Now, with that explained, Industrial Surfaces gave a quote of roughly \$100k to do the work described above as an Overlay Type 1, which is the more complex overlay. He stated that our courts were good candidates for this work, and explained the process to Chris, Mark and I. As Chris stated, there is no guarantee with this work, which is common in our climate, given the weather conditions, but it one that is readily done in our area. He felt that our surface and underlying layers were stable, and that it would probably last for a good while.

Next, as Chris stated, we spoke with Vasco. The estimator that was out, stated that he was out in around 2014 to look at our courts, and it was recommended at that time that they be replaced due to age. The options that he gave were to either:

1. At a cost estimate of 225k - (New playing court surface, retaining fencing and alleyways)

- They would saw cut all around the internal dimensions of the courts, parallel to all fencing, down to the base layer,
- Remove all of the material, to the base,
- Pour new asphalt back into the exposed area,
- Seal, coat and paint the courts and alleyway between the two banks of courts to specifications.
- Leave all fencing, posts as-is.
- **For an additional cost of 40k, they would remove the fencing and posts, and replace with new fencing**
- **For an additional cost of 25k, they would install new drainage around the courts**

2. At a cost estimate of 300-325k - (Completely new courts / facility)

- Remove all fencing and posts,
- Dig up and remove entire surface, including alleyways,
- Lay down new courts, fencing, posts, etc.,
- Seal, coat and paint to specifications.

Now, as you can see, both from my email as well as the one from Chris's summary, there is a substantial cost difference between the amount that Vasco provided directly to us for the courts vs. the amount provided through Shook Construction. In speaking with Chris, there is a **substantial** premium that is being added by them to project manage this undertaking, thus driving up the cost a considerable amount. On average, it is a reasonable assumption that it should cost roughly 50-60k, to build a tennis court. We have five courts, so given the direct estimates from Vasco of 300k for a complete rebuild, is in that range. To obtain that price, or one lower, regardless of what option we would use with Vasco, the district would be the project manager at-risk, as opposed to Shook Construction. Given the fact that there are many courts in our area that have been rebuilt using Vasco, and that they are a reputable company, I do not see why this cannot be the route that we take. To give an example, Hudson school district rebuilt 6 courts roughly 3-5 years ago using Vasco. Hudson school district was also the at-risk project manager for said courts, which saved them a considerable amount of money. Their courts are in excellent condition, and there are others who have had the same experience.

To sum it all up, given the comparisons between the two types of overlays, and the costs of new courts, given the two options from Vasco, I have the following:

When I consider the price differential between the more expensive overlay that was recommended by Industrial Surfaces (100k), and the two rebuild options provided from Vasco, (225k & 300k), I feel that the best option is to reconstruct everything, for the 300k. Our fences are old, and have rusted, and were already repainted 10 years ago, so I personally think that if you have the option to reconstruct everything for that cost, that it should be done. Now, when I also think about it, the main underlying problem with these courts is that the surface is well past its life-span. Those courts are at least 30+ years old, and have never been overlain with asphalt. The average tennis court lifespan is 20 - 25 years within our climate, assuming there is periodic upkeep, (just like anything that you purchase and maintain for longevity), and ours have done very well considering this age. The surface is incredibly level, which is why I, as well as the two estimators that have been out, believe that there is a solid foundation under those courts. The drainage has been great since the installation of the french drain beneath the alleyway, 8-10 years ago, and there is no seepage occurring.

We are having a meeting on Monday, after our matches conclude with all parents and students that wish to attend, to explain the various options, and the potential consequences of pursuing those options, which I can share at the meeting on Tuesday. Jeff and I are well aware that by not going with the city hall 2 court option, that we may have to go on the road for matches again, and I will reiterate that point to my parents and athletes as well. But, with knowing all this, my

recommendations are as follows, and I strongly feel that in having spoke about this with my parents and athletes through questions and comments they have made to me, that they would agree with the following:

Assuming that all comes back OK with the core samples at our current site, which I think it will, I would recommend that we:

1. Carry out the 300k option to completely rebuild the courts OR
2. Carry out the 225k option to rebuild the courts, leaving the materials in place, and refurbish the area around the courts , (as Chris mentioned to me at one of our meetings on Thursday) ,with nicer bleachers, similar to the baseball field, paved steps going down the courts, etc.

Both of the above options provide a new playing surface, AND the life expectancy of 20-25 years from the courts.

I do not recommend that we proceed with the City Hall option based on the rationale that I mentioned at the meeting for the two major reasons:

1. The building of two courts, a good distance away from the other three is not at all conducive to coaching a team. I have been to many courts and facilities to play tournaments and matches through the years, and I can honestly say that there are NO facilities that have courts separated by a barrier (baseball field) or a distance such that you cannot see courts, and players from one bank to another. For coaching, practicing and liability purposes, the team is supposed to be together, and from any standpoint I look at, this would make that very hard to accomplish.
2. The three courts that are already present, are not at all in good condition. Of the three, there is one, (the one closest to the train car) that is in OK condition. Being that these courts were built as "recreational" courts rather than USTA courts designed for competitive play, the spacing between them is an issue, as well as the major slope with the two courts on the end. Once again, there exists no tennis facility that I have ever been to where there is a slope even close to as deep as what is at those courts. Furthermore, If you were to go out and bounce a ball in various places on the courts, there are major dead spots on them, where the ball will not bounce, rather just die once it hits the court. Although to non-tennis players, these courts look to be in excellent condition, to which I understand, but when you play on them, they are truly bad courts. In reflecting back to my commentary on the different types of overlays, earlier in this email, the reason the courts "look good" is because they have been overlaid with the mesh material, and then painted. What happens when you do this is that the mesh will sometimes lift off of the underlying surface, creating these dead zones. I am welcome to go out and meet anyone who is interested to show you exactly what I'm speaking of, but if you walk or press on certain sections of the courts, the surface also presses down, because the acrylic type sheet is lifted, but the coating is still on.

For these reasons, and from a tennis standpoint, I do not recommend this option at all. Our courts have not had a significant investment for a great deal of years, and with anything that is subjected to the elements, there comes a time when it needs replaced. Our courts are not unique in needing this replacement, as it has been long overdue, and a project that several area districts have undertaken over the past few years. What really stands out for me, speaking solely from a financial standpoint is the fact that:

For 300k, we would be getting completely new facilities (5 courts) at our current site from Vasco, (If we Project Manage).

For 225k, we would be getting completely new surface to the base, (5 courts) at our current site from Vasco (If we Project Manage)

For 275k, we are getting 2 brand new courts, at the city hall property, that would be linked to the three existing courts, that are in questionable condition.

I know from a financial standpoint, the offer from the city to maintain the courts for 20 years is very enticing, however, if you selected either of the two rebuild options at our current courts, your life expectancy is still 20-25 years, making that "maintenance" an essential "wash". We are paying **more** in the city hall scenario above, for two courts, than we are for 5 new courts at the current site, by 50k, based on the second option. Furthermore, Sue has begun the process for applying for a USTA grant to assist with the rebuild of our courts. This is a multi-step process, and requires some write-ups, and other specifications, but is potential money up to \$50k that may be awarded, which would help.

I see a major part of my job as the coach of my teams to represent, above all, what is in the best interest of my athletes, and I would be lying if I said that the city hall plan is what is best for this program, not only from a monetary sense, but also a practicality sense. After speaking directly with the estimator from Vasco, their options could be completed sometime in April/May/June (prior to the start of the girls season), and although this would mean road matches for the boys again, it would be entirely worth it knowing that we were doing so because a long term solution was being implemented. I want great facilities for all of the sports that are played in our district, believe me, and I also understand the quandaries associated with costs of said facilities. I truly appreciate these discussions, and please do

not view my honesty, as being negative or unappreciative. My wife and I have taught and coached in this district for 14 years, we live in this district, and our kids attend school in this district, and we want nothing but the best for everyone in this district, regardless if it is my children or those of another.

Even knowing that it may mean more work for Jeff and I as coaches to suspend the city hall option, to pursue the actions at our current site, I feel confidently in that decision. I will definitely share any and all feedback from my parents and athletes as well, after our meeting on Monday night, but I know their feelings, and we are on the same page regarding these options.

I apologize for this being so long, but I felt it important to be said...

Please feel free to share any feedback you may have.

Take care, Dan

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On Fri, Sep 20, 2019 at 5:24 PM Christopher Coad <coadc@bbhcsd.org> wrote:
Dan,

Thanks for your involvement and input into the process. It seemed that yesterday's meeting with contractors was somewhat educational for you and Mark Maslona and provided you a first hand opportunity to hear the risk involved in an asphalt top coating repair to the existing tennis courts. After meeting with 2 different contractors you should also have become aware of the many different approaches, design deviations and costs surrounding a project of this scope. As previously stated, I will not recommend the Board undertake a project of this nature without going through a public bid process or using our construction manager.

Again, the complexities of this project lead us to the 2 primary options available to the school district to facilitate installation of new courts or repair of the existing courts: public bid or construction manager at risk. Each of these processes require a detailed written specification to secure competitive pricing. As discussed, each process provides different benefits and challenges. ***At this time it becomes counterproductive to solicit pricing from contractors without a specification.*** Again, yesterday's meeting with contractors demonstrated how contractors may approach this type of project without specific guidance, please recall that pricing was irregular and as we asked questions of these contractors the prices generally went up.

In my opinion there are 2 primary questions before the tennis parents and stakeholders:

1. Do we build 2 new tennis courts at the City site. Current Estimated price \$275,000 - It is my understanding that there is a 20 year shared use agreement affiliated with this plan.
2. Can 5 new courts be built at the existing location for the same price that will provide the Board and community a 20+ year life expectancy? Is the Vasco partial repair an option? What will this really cost? Is an asphalt topcoat an option? What will this really cost?

The professional opinions the district has received related to the amount of work required to build new tennis courts on the existing site is why the Board has chosen the first option and the Construction Manager at Risk process as the most responsible approach to addressing the present condition of our tennis courts. Mr. Dosen is correct, continued delay in moving forward with our current plan has the risk of further impact to the students that choose to play tennis.

Again, please recall the public bid timeline I shared with you yesterday. The school district must be out for bid in January 2020 at the latest to insure a strong contractor pool and the most competitive pricing. This timeline will apply to all options available for rebuilding tennis courts at our existing site at the current budget of \$275,000 and could possibly impact 2020 spring and fall tennis. Are all of the tennis families aware of this risk? Being aware of this risk are they

willing to support the Board in continuing to delay the City court plan to allow us the opportunity to pursue option 2? If option 2 comes in over budget we should expect a cost escalation and further delay in construction of new tennis courts.

It is important to note ***that poor soil borings at the current tennis court site may completely eliminate any form of option 2 as fiscally possible.***

Go Bees!

On Fri, Sep 13, 2019 at 11:51 AM Daniel Reynolds <reynoldsd@bbhcsd.org> wrote:

Chris and Mark - As promised from our meeting yesterday, I have a list of companies that may be contacted in order to find out more information regarding the proposal of top-coating our current courts. What a general top-coating would entail is:

1. Properly sealing all of the cracks that are currently in the courts, using asphalt tape, or other materials, to ensure that water penetration is halted.
2. Potentially, adjusting the net post settings to accommodate for the increase in asphalt.
3. Applying a solid layer of blacktop material over top of the current courts, once crack sealing has been completed and allowed to dry.
4. Preparing the new surface by applying the paints and topcoats, to seal off any potential moisture penetration.

This process is different in what was done back in 2009/10, in which they: removed all of the fencing and posts, reset all posts and fencing, sealed cracks, and painted a new surface. With the addition of the solid asphalt layer, and given the lack of seepage at the current courts, I feel that this could be done both economically and soundly. Upon speaking with a certified company, however, while they are at the site to evaluate, they would probably be able to give a more accurate analysis than mine.

I am more than willing to contact these companies today as well, to get them out as soon as possible, as there is a time crunch to get this evaluation completed prior to the next board meeting. Also, some of the parents have requested that when the contractors are at the courts giving their evaluations/estimates, that I be present as well, so that I may hear the conclusions first hand, and report back to them the viability of said repairs.

Chris - Below is a list of companies that may be contacted to complete this job:

Industrial Surface: 216-341-2662

All American Track and Tennis: 440-986-8729

Total Tennis: 614-488-5004 (They are out of Columbus, but have done courts in Northeast Ohio)

Sportmaster Tennis court Resurfacing: 1-800-395-7325

Vasco: 330-832-5151 (I know it was stated that they were already contacted for court replacement, but do not know if they were ever asked to do the work outlined above)

North Coast Paving: 216-421-1203

Concord Paving: 440-354-8580

Please let me know what I may do to facilitate this process, as I will make myself available for any steps as necessary.

Thank you again for meeting with all of us yesterday, for it truly means a lot for us to be a part of this discussion.

Dan

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9/24/2019

Dosen1.com Mail - Re: Tennis Courts

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